

Hop onto the (Joli)Cloud

OS
Review

Jolicloud transforms your netbook into a sophisticated Web device that taps into the cloud to expand your computing possibilities. The Web already hosts a significant part of our lives: e-mails, photos, videos and friends are already somewhere online. Jolicloud was built to amalgamate the computer and Web part of the same experience.

The OS was created by Tariq Krim, founder and ex-CEO of Netvibes. The developer team has a huge inclination towards the Web, so they built the user interface mostly using its core technologies (HTML, JavaScript and CSS). They have integrated our Web DNA into the OS to make it modular, social and personal. The developer platform relies on the Web and will let anyone or any service join in no time. With their API, developers will have the ability to let their website communicate with the computer directly, with no need for code specific native applications.

How to get it

Unfortunately, as of writing this article, JoliCloud is in private alpha. However, you can ask for an invitation link at <http://url.shayonpal.com/jolicloud>.

After you get the invitation code in your inbox, use that to get registered (keep the credentials, you will need them later) and download the ISO file. After that, download the USB Creator software from <http://url.shayonpal.com/JoliUSBCreator>.

Installation

Now, fire up the terminal and go to the directory where you downloaded the JoliCloud USB Creator.

```
cd /the/path/to/your/directory
chmod a+x jolicloud-usb-creator-1.1.2.sh
./jolicloud-usb-creator-1.1.2.sh
```



▲ JoliCloud USB Creator

At the last step, you will be asked for the admin password.

1. Now, connect the thumb drive to your computer.
2. In the JoliCloud USB Creator window, click *Browse* to find and select the Jolicloud image you've downloaded.
3. Select your target device: The USB key you have inserted should be automatically detected.
4. Click *Create* to create your Jolicloud USB.

We have finally managed to create a bootable USB drive with a copy of JoliCloud in it. Now, insert the USB key into your computer and boot off it. In the boot menu, select 'Install JoliCloud'.

Activate your JoliCloud account

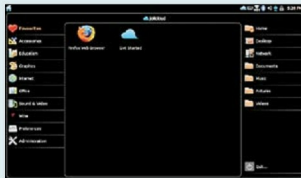
Yes, this is what will distinguish JoliCloud from any other operating system. Do you remember that you had registered on the JoliCloud website? Well, we will need those credentials now.

Get your netbook connected to the Internet and then click on the little cloud on the system tray. Alternatively, you can also click on 'Get Started' on the 'Favourites' launcher menu.

Enter your username and password, and you are connected with the (Joli)Cloud.

The desktop

Upon booting Jolicloud, you'll notice instantly that



▲ The default/home screen



▲ Logging into the JoliCloud's Web service.